

# Microsoft Word vs. Google Docs

*A comprehensive, evidence-backed demonstration document*

**Positioning thesis**

Word provides the real-time collaboration people expect from modern cloud editors while adding deeper professional document production, formal review, rich desktop features, enterprise security, automation, accessibility, and file-format control.

|                                |                                                                                  |
|--------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b><u>Prepared for</u></b>     | <u>Executive / Sales / IT decision-makers</u>                                    |
| <b><u>Prepared by</u></b>      | <u>Microsoft Word capability team</u>                                            |
| <b><u>Date</u></b>             | <u>2026-07-03</u>                                                                |
| <b><u>Document purpose</u></b> | <u>Prove “all they have plus more” with Word features embedded in this .docx</u> |
| <b><u>Status</u></b>           | <u>Draft for review – use Track Changes and comments for sign-off</u>            |

**Table of Contents**

Tip: In Word, right-click **~~Document 100 – Ultimate Demo~~**

**~~This is the 100th document demonstrating multiple formatting features.~~**

**~~This final document showcases~~ the Table of Contents  
and choose “Update Field” to refresh page numbers.**

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## 1. Executive summary

Microsoft Word should be positioned as the premium document platform: it matches the cloud collaboration benefits commonly associated with Google Docs, then extends beyond them with mature legal-grade review, long-document production, advanced layout, enterprise-grade protection, automation, accessibility, and integration across Microsoft 365.

## 3. Capability matrix: Word has all the expected basics plus professional depth

| Capability                     | Google Docs expectation                       | Microsoft Word answer                                                                                    | Word advantage                                                                |
|--------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <u>Real-time coauthoring</u>   | <u>Multiple users edit in a browser</u>       | <u>Coauthoring in Word desktop/web when stored in OneDrive/SharePoint</u>                                | <u>Collaboration with desktop-grade layout and review controls</u>            |
| <u>Comments &amp; mentions</u> | <u>Comments, suggestions, action items</u>    | <u>Threaded comments, @mentions, tasks, resolved threads</u>                                             | <u>Integrated with Outlook/Teams/Microsoft 365 identity</u>                   |
| <u>Change review</u>           | <u>Suggesting mode</u>                        | <u>Track Changes: insertions, deletions, formatting, reviewer identity, accept/reject, lock tracking</u> | <u>More formal review workflow for legal, editorial, regulated documents</u>  |
| <u>Version history</u>         | <u>Restore prior versions</u>                 | <u>Version history through OneDrive/SharePoint; local file versioning options</u>                        | <u>Cloud + enterprise repositories + records processes</u>                    |
| <u>Long documents</u>          | <u>Headings, outline, basic TOC</u>           | <u>TOC, captions, cross-references, indexes, bibliography, fields, master-document practices</u>         | <u>Better for reports, contracts, manuals, theses</u>                         |
| <u>Formatting/design</u>       | <u>Basic styles/tables/images</u>             | <u>Advanced styles, themes, columns, section breaks, page setup, watermarks, object placement</u>        | <u>Higher-fidelity professional output</u>                                    |
| <u>Mail merge</u>              | <u>Requires add-ons/workarounds</u>           | <u>Native mail merge with Excel/Outlook data</u>                                                         | <u>Production-ready personalized letters, labels, envelopes, email merges</u> |
| <u>Automation</u>              | <u>Apps Script/add-ons</u>                    | <u>VBA macros, Office Scripts ecosystem, COM/add-ins, Power Automate, content controls</u>               | <u>Broader enterprise automation surface</u>                                  |
| <u>Security/compliance</u>     | <u>Drive permissions/admin controls</u>       | <u>Purview labels, encryption, DLP, retention/eDiscovery integration, IRM, protected view</u>            | <u>Deeper Microsoft 365 governance stack</u>                                  |
| <u>AI assistance</u>           | <u>Gemini/Smart Compose depending on plan</u> | <u>Copilot in Word plus Editor, summaries, drafting, rewrite, M365 grounding where licensed</u>          | <u>AI integrated with M365 data and compliance controls</u>                   |
| <u>Offline capability</u>      | <u>Offline mode after setup</u>               | <u>Full desktop application plus offline files synced later</u>                                          | <u>Most capable no-internet document editor</u>                               |
| <u>Compatibility</u>           | <u>Imports/exports DOCX</u>                   | <u>Native DOCX fidelity and</u>                                                                          | <u>Best authoritative format</u>                                              |